



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: North Phoenix Preparatory Academy
School Website: <https://northphoenixprep.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

North Phoenix Preparatory Academy (NPX), as reflected in publicly accessible materials from its Great Hearts/North Phoenix Prep ecosystem, demonstrates robust alignment with classical education principles. The school emphasizes a classical liberal arts curriculum anchored in Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, a strong emphasis on Great Books and the Western tradition, Socratic dialogue and Humane Letters seminars, a well-defined college-preparatory outcome, and a clearly articulated partnership with families and the broader community. Across the six classical elements framework, NPX consistently signals formation of character, rigorous liberal arts study, and a pedagogy that blends contemplation with rigorous inquiry. Evidence from NPX materials shows explicit commitments to classical curriculum, Socratic pedagogy, humane letters, a focus on virtue, and active parent involvement. While the public-facing materials do not foreground liturgical or formal theological practices, they do place moral formation and transcendentals (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) at the center of student formation.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

This assessment uses the knowledge-base rubric of the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School, focusing on keywords and phrases that indicate adherence to the six classical categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community) and cross-checks with explicit Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators drawn from the knowledge-document set. The NPX materials show strong positive signals in every category, with explicit articulation of Great Books, humane letters, Socratic dialogue, the Great Conversation, and a formation emphasis consistent with classical education. See category-by-category notes below for the keyword analyses and the justification of each category's rating.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Explicit articulation of Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; Socratic dialogue; Great Books; adherence to a transcendent ideal of education. Negative signals (theological/Liturgical) are not foregrounded in public materials, though the Great Hearts framework often implies a Christian formation context in practice. Positive keyword indicators: truth, goodness, beauty, great conversation, Socratic dialogue, virtue, formation, wisdom, moral imagination, contemplation, Logos/metaphysical order signals (where present in provided texts), living books (references to core canonical texts). Why: The public-facing content centers on transcendental aims and rigorous moral/intellectual formation, with canonical texts and dialogue as core methods.
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** The mission and outcomes emphasize character formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not simply employment; ongoing reference to Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; "great-hearted leaders" and service orientation. Positive keyword indicators: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, human flourishing, moral imagination, character development, great conversation, formation through the arts. Why: The school's stated aims center on formation of character and intellect in the classical sense, not primarily job preparation.

- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit classical liberal arts framing; emphasis on Great Books; Humane Letters; a curriculum anchored in grammar, logic, rhetoric, history through the Western tradition; limited electives; emphasis on integration of literature, history, science, languages, and the arts. Positive keyword indicators: liberal arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, Humane Letters, rhetoric, grammar, logic, mathematics, science, history, Western tradition, classical canon, integration of disciplines, memorability/formation through texts. Why: The materials consistently describe a classical curriculum architecture, with primary texts and liberal-arts content as central.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL Evidence: Socratic seminars for upper grades; daily humane letters seminars; direct reference to a Socratic method; lower-school practices (memory, recitation, and, where noted, singing) to deepen memory; emphasis on contemplative, rigorous inquiry paired with Socratic discussion. Positive keyword indicators: Socratic dialogue, seminars, Socratic method, Humane Letters seminars, Great Conversation, contemplation, memory work, chant/singing in lower grades (if present as described). Why: NPX publicly describes a pedagogy that blends contemplative, Socratic inquiry with rigorous discussions, consistent with classical pedagogy.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Emphasis on model teachers who are “models of learning and character”; small-class environments; teachers as the living curriculum; professional development; a culture of mentorship and collegiality among teachers and students. Positive keyword indicators: small class size, models of learning, mentors, living curriculum, teacher as exemplar, collegiality, character modeling. Why: The materials frame faculty as central to the classical formation of students, with explicit claims about teacher quality and the teacher’s role as curriculum.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Explicit calls for parent involvement; partnerships with families; family/campus tours; resources aimed at educating parents about classical education; calendar and academy-life communications that invite parental engagement. Positive keyword indicators: partnership with families, parental engagement, home-school collaboration, parent involvement, school tours, community formation, parent education, living tradition in the family. Why: NPX materials emphasize ongoing, active parental partnership and open lines of communication, consistent with classical education expectations for family engagement.

What would move the needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No needle-moving changes are required to achieve a CLASSICAL rating.

Now, category-by-category detail with keyword analyses and evidence

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school anchors education in a triadic ideal (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) within a classical framework, including emphasis on a Great Conversation of the Western tradition and a virtue-centered formation approach. Public materials state that NPX participates in a classical liberal arts curriculum dedicated to Truth, Beauty, and Goodness. - The middle/high school curriculum emphasizes virtue education woven into all aspects of learning, with a focus on memory, discernment, and character formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (examples): truth, goodness, beauty, great conversation, Socratic dialogue, virtue, formation, wisdom, moral imagination, contemplation, order, harmony. - Negative keywords present: Minimal to none in public-facing materials regarding secularism, relativism, or value-neutral approaches. The materials concentrate on transcendent ideals rather than secular ethics; however, explicit theological liturgy or formal worship is not foregrounded in the public materials reviewed (which is a mild gap relative to some classical schools that foreground liturgical practices). See Positive Keywords list for what counts as Positive signals in this category, and Negative Keywords list in the Six Essential Elements document for contrast.

Why this rating - NPX shows clear alignment with transcendental aims (Truth, Goodness, Beauty) and with Socratic dialogue and Great Books as vehicles for formational education. It lacks explicit public statements about liturgical or formal theological structures on the school’s public-facing site, but the core Classical

Foundations (truth/goodness/beauty, virtue formation, and Great Conversations) are strongly present. This combination aligns with a CLASSICAL designation in this category.

Cited sources - Truth, Beauty, Goodness, and Great Conversations: NPX materials emphasize Truth, Beauty, Goodness and the Great Conversation of Western tradition. - Socratic dialogue in the public-facing descriptions: NPX describes Socratic dialogue as a driver of inquiry. - Virtue formation and character formation: The heart of NPX's program is virtue education and formation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission and outcomes center on cultivating minds and hearts through Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; forming great-hearted leaders rather than merely pursuing job preparation. Public statements emphasize formation over mere information, with strong virtue formation and intellectual formation as the aim. - The school also emphasizes a character-education focus (virtue, moral imagination) and service to community as part of formation, consistent with classical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, character development, moral imagination, wonder, service to community, great conversation. - Negative keywords present: None clearly evident in the public-facing materials (no explicit job-prep or purely skills-based framing). The materials emphasize formation and character over vocational metrics. The classical-negative indicators from the Six Elements document (e.g., a focus on job-work readiness over transcendent aims) are not evidenced in NPX's public materials.

Why this rating - NPX clearly articulates formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom as school goals, aligning with CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT or NOT CLASSICAL categorizations in this category.

Cited sources - Mission to cultivate minds/hearts through Truth, Goodness, Beauty: - Formation over information; virtue education:

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as a classical liberal arts program, with focus on Western canon, Great Books, and the Great Conversation. The curriculum spans grammar, logic, rhetoric, history, science, mathematics, languages, and the arts; humane letters and seminary-based seminars appear in high school. - High school emphasis on Humane Letters seminars (Socratic, literature, philosophy, history) and honors-level courses rooted in the Western tradition. □filecite□turn12□ - The curriculum explicitly references Great Books, the Western tradition, and a unified liberal arts approach across the upper grades (6–12).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, humane letters, rhetoric, grammar, logic, mathematics, history, Western tradition, contemplation, formation through the arts, living books. - Negative keywords present: The public-facing materials do not emphasize non-classical or secular-skewed approaches; there is minimal reference to elective diversification (and a note that NPX has limited electives) which aligns with classical expectations of a coherent core curriculum. The lack of electives is a potential caveat for some classical rubrics but remains consistent with a classical curriculum approach in many classical programs (as described in the knowledge base on classical curricula).

Why this rating - NPX describes a robust classical curriculum centered on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium concepts via a Great Books-centric Western canon; Humane Letters seminars in the upper grades and a strong emphasis on primary texts and canonical works align with CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT or NOT CLASSICAL classifications.

Cited sources - Classical liberal arts curriculum with Truth/Beauty/Goodness emphasis: - Humane Letters seminars and Socratic approach in high school: □filecite□turn12□ - High-level curriculum outline and Great

Books emphasis:

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The pedagogy includes Socratic dialogue and seminars (upper grades) and a Socratic-based Humane Letters program; lower grades emphasize memory and engagement (singing as memory/retention device). The combination signals a pedagogy that blends contemplative memory work with rigorous Socratic inquiry. □filecite□turn12□ - The public materials describe a two-tiered pedagogy: lower-school practices (memory, singing) and upper-school practices (Socratic dialogue, seminars, rhetorical training, public speaking). □filecite□turn12□ - Statements about the value of virtuous inquiry and the use of Great Books as the anchor for lit/History/Philosophy discussions.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminars, humane letters, memory/recitation, contemplation, great conversation, rhetoric, public speaking, inquiry-based discussion. - Negative keywords present: None significant in public-facing materials; there is no indication of project-based or purely experiential learning being emphasized as the primary pedagogy, which aligns with a classical leaning rather than a non-classical style.

Why this rating - NPX's teaching approach explicitly includes Socratic methods, seminars, and a graduated pedagogy that moves from memory-based learning in the lower grades to rigorous Socratic inquiry and rhetoric in the upper grades, consistent with CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Cited sources - Humane Letters Seminars and Socratic seminars: □filecite□turn12□ - Lower-to-upper school pedagogy and public statements about truth and conscious formation:

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials emphasize “dedicated, enthusiastic, and intellectually excellent teachers who serve as models of learning and character” and describe faculty as central to the living curriculum. Small class sizes and a teacher-led, mentorship-oriented culture are highlighted. - The publicly available materials portray faculty as a core element of the school's mission, with teachers fostering both intellect and virtue. The school's charter materials emphasize a “living curriculum” enacted by teachers and mentors.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: dedicated teachers, models of learning, mentors, living curriculum, small class sizes, teacher as exemplar, collegial culture. - Negative keywords present: None significant in public materials; the focus remains on teacher quality and mentorship rather than a purely corporate or impersonal staffing narrative.

Why this rating - NPX's emphasis on virtuous modeling by faculty, teacher as living curriculum, and small-class, mentorship-oriented culture aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for the faculty category.

Cited sources - Description of faculty as models of learning and character; small class sizes: - Living curriculum and teacher-student mentorship framing:

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - NPX materials emphasize partnership with families and parent involvement, access and tours, and educational resources for families to understand classical education. There are explicit invitations for parents to visit and engage with the academy; communications stress parent partnership and ongoing involvement. - The school's charter and family-facing materials articulate a commitment to parent participation, shared mission, and home-school collaboration; materials also highlight opportunities for parent education and book studies to deepen classical understanding.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent involvement, parental engagement, family formation, home-school connection, parent education, school-tour access, community of learners. - Negative keywords present: None evident; there is no push toward minimal parent involvement in public-facing materials.

Why this rating - NPX presents a robust, explicit stance on parental partnership and community engagement, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for the Parent & Community category.

Cited sources - Parent involvement and family partnership language: - Mission/charter materials emphasizing the school-community partnership and family engagement:

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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